

Japan Electronic Components: August MOF trade data (MLCC): mom decline on seasonality, but expect stronger momentum from September

According to Ministry of Finance (MOF) trade statistics for August, announced on September 29, the average export price for MLCCs was up +3% mom, while export volume was down -16%, and export value was down -14%. On a yoy basis, these figures were +33%, -6%, and +24%, respectively. We believe the mom decline in volume and value reflects usual seasonality due to the summer holidays, and we expect momentum to strengthen again from September onward. ASP has risen both mom and yoy, which we assume reflects an increasing contribution from AI/DC applications, which have higher average unit prices.

We maintain our Buy ratings on Murata Mfg. (on CL), Taiyo Yuden, and TDK. At the 1H results, we expect positive views on **Murata Mfg.** to strengthen further across the board in terms of profitability, growth potential, and competitiveness, driven by 2Q earnings beating guidance, an upward revision to full-year guidance, increased MLCC production/capacity utilization, improved product mix, and a favorable 2H outlook. Although investor valuation of the company is rising again, we maintain our bullish stance.

Meanwhile, we also expect a share price catch-up for Taiyo Yuden and TDK at their 1H results. Regarding **Taiyo Yuden**, the equity market may be underestimating the benefits from MLCCs for AI/DC applications and the operating leverage as utilization rates rise. If company-wide OPM in 2Q exceeds 10% in line with guidance, it could act as a catalyst for improved valuation.

We believe **TDK's** true earnings capability may also be underestimated. We assume its valuation will improve as a substantial upward revision to full-year guidance and its growth potential from FY3/27 onward (driven by HDD-related products, medium-sized batteries for data centers, and earnings improvements in passive components) become more visible.

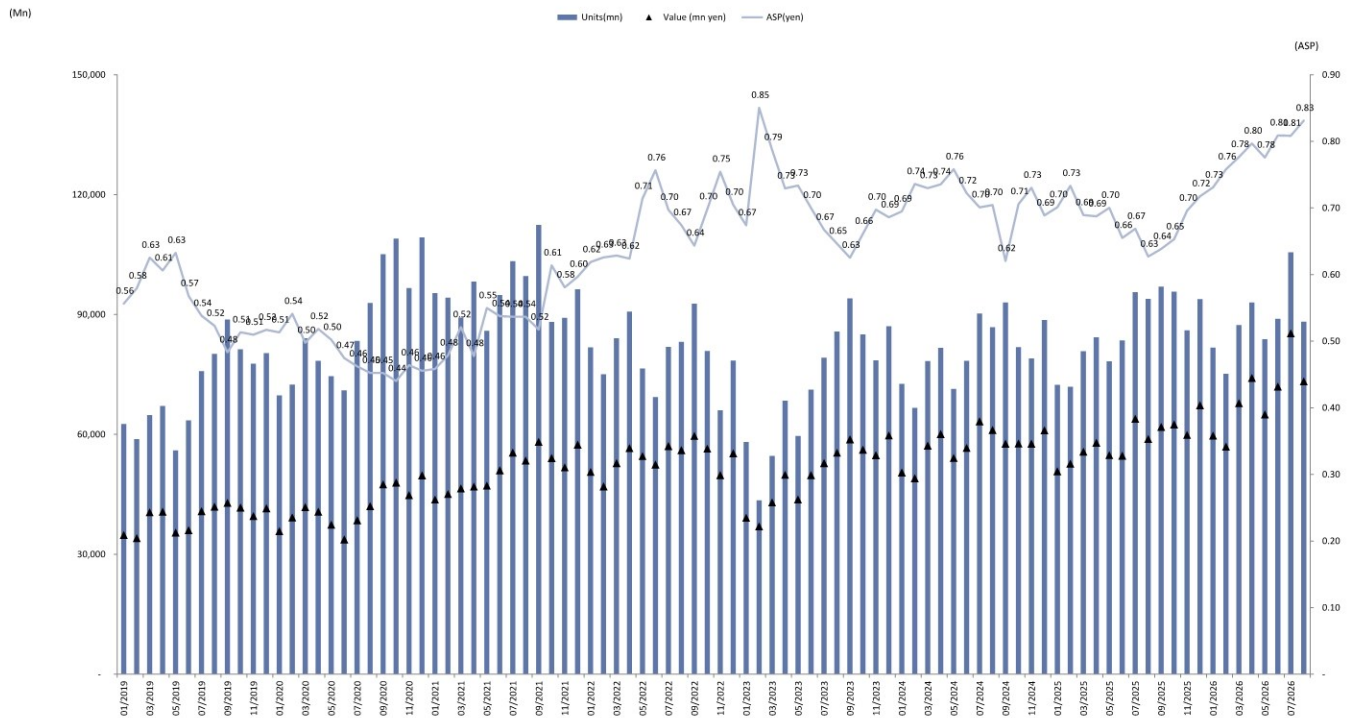
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Exhibit 1: MLCC export volume and average export price (ASP)

Source: Ministry of Finance

Price Target Risks and Methodology**Price Target Risks and Methodology – Murata Mfg.**

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on Murata Mfg. with a 12-month price target of ¥12,900. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (implies FY3/29E P/E of 30X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – Taiyo Yuden

Valuation methodology: We are Buy-rated on Taiyo Yuden with a 12-month price target of ¥21,300. Our target price is based on FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying an 80% premium to our sector multiple of 10X (our TP implies FY3/29E P/E of 31X).

Key risks: Weaker-than-expected smartphone demand, deterioration in MLCC supply/demand, and yen appreciation.

Price Target Risks and Methodology – TDK

Valuation methodology: We are Buy rated on TDK with a 12-month price target of

¥4,900. Our target price is based on a FY3/29E EV/GCI vs. CROCI/WACC, applying a 10% premium to our sector average EV/DACF multiple of 10X (implies FY3/28E P/E of 27X).

Key risks: Decline in smartphone production volume, higher input costs, and yen appreciation.

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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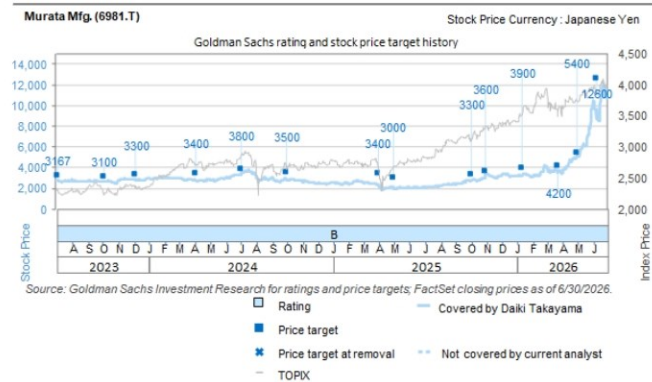
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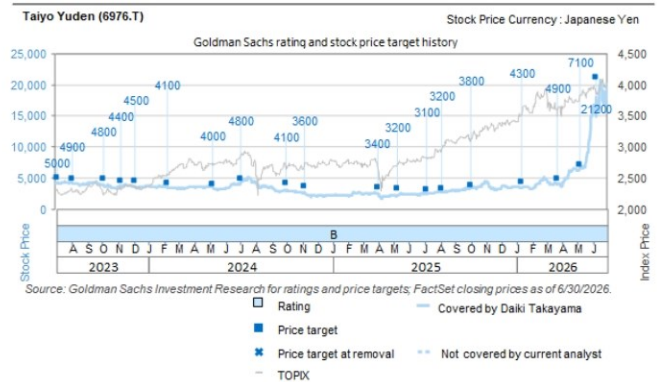
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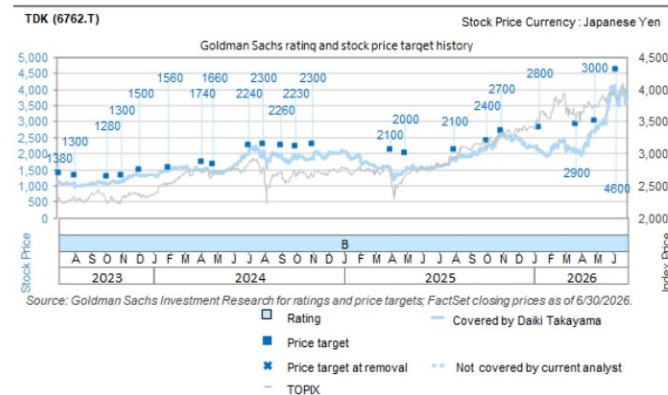
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Target price history table(s)

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
05-Aug-26	21,300	11,165
08-Jun-26	21,200	14,975
08-May-26	7,100	6,663
23-Mar-26	4,900	3,926
12-Jan-26	4,300	3,405
02-Oct-25	3,800	3,382
05-Aug-25	3,200	2,841
07-Jul-25	3,100	2,488
09-May-25	3,200	2,202
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,467
07-Nov-24	3,600	2,781
01-Oct-24	4,100	3,081
02-Jul-24	4,800	4,105

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	12,900	7,416
08-Jun-26	12,600	8,711
30-Apr-26	5,400	5,156
23-Mar-26	4,200	3,508
12-Jan-26	3,900	3,194
31-Oct-25	3,600	3,392
02-Oct-25	3,300	2,770
30-Apr-25	3,000	2,214
31-Mar-25	3,400	2,306
01-Oct-24	3,500	2,893
02-Jul-24	3,800	3,364
03-Apr-24	3,400	2,768
06-Dec-23	3,300	2,892

Taiyo Yuden (6976.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
08-May-24	4,000	3,643
07-Feb-24	4,100	3,431
06-Dec-23	4,500	3,627
07-Nov-23	4,400	3,695
04-Oct-23	4,800	3,963

Murata Mfg. (6981.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
04-Oct-23	3,100	2,657

TDK (6762.T)

Date of report	Target price (¥)	Closing price (¥)
31-Jul-26	4,900	3,008
08-Jun-26	4,600	3,715
28-Apr-26	3,000	2,677
23-Mar-26	2,900	2,043
12-Jan-26	2,800	2,142
31-Oct-25	2,700	2,673
02-Oct-25	2,400	2,154
01-Aug-25	2,100	1,876
28-Apr-25	2,000	1,460
31-Mar-25	2,100	1,546
01-Nov-24	2,300	1,848
01-Oct-24	2,230	1,948
02-Sep-24	11,300	2,023
30-Jul-24	11,500	2,029
02-Jul-24	11,200	2,004
26-Apr-24	8,300	1,462
03-Apr-24	8,700	1,488
31-Jan-24	7,800	1,488
06-Dec-23	7,500	1,338
01-Nov-23	6,500	1,158
04-Oct-23	6,400	1,052

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